

PassportSahayak AI

Knowledge Base Document

Fraud, Misconduct & KB Administration

Fraud Reporting, Misconduct Procedures, CVC/ACB Referral & KB Ingestion Administration

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1. Purpose & Scope

This document defines the fraud and misconduct reporting procedures for the Passport Seva Programme, including bribery and corruption referrals to CVC and ACB, disputed parentage and denied NOC escalation procedures, and the Knowledge Base (KB) administration process for PassportSahayak AI. It is intended for PSK Managers, RPO officials, and KB Administrators.

2. Fraud Detection & Reporting

2.1 Categories of Passport Fraud

Fraud Category	Indicators	Severity
Document Forgery	Inconsistent fonts, altered dates, mismatched seals, documents from unrecognised institutions	Critical
Identity Impersonation	Biometric mismatch, photo substitution, use of another person's credentials	Critical
Suppression of Information	Undisclosed criminal history, concealed pending cases, multiple passports not declared	High
Agent / Broker Fraud	Unofficial agents charging fees for 'faster' processing, forged appointment confirmations	High
Duplicate Passport Fraud	Multiple active passports under same identity via different RPOs	Critical
Online Phishing	Fake Passport Seva Portal lookalike sites collecting fees and documents	High
Internal Misconduct	PSK/RPO officials facilitating fraudulent issuance for consideration	Critical
PV Corruption	PV officer extorting payment for a favourable verification report	Critical

2.2 Fraud Reporting Procedure — Citizens

Step	Action	Channel
1	Refuse any unofficial fee or bribery demand	—
2	Record details: official name/badge number, date, time, location, demand made	—
3	Report immediately to PSK Manager or RPO Grievance Cell	In-person / phone
4	File formal complaint on National Grievance Portal	PGPortal.gov.in
5	File FIR with Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB) of the respective state	State ACB website / police station
6	For central government officials: report to Central Vigilance Commission (CVC)	cvc.gov.in / 1800-11-0180
7	Retain all evidence: messages, emails, receipts	—

2.3 Fraud Reporting Procedure — PSK/RPO Officials

- Suspected document forgery at counter: DO NOT process — place On Hold; inform PSK Manager immediately
- PSK Manager must preserve physical documents and notify RPO and nearest police station within 2 hours
- All suspected fraud cases must be reported to RPO via internal fraud reporting form PSK-FRAUD-001
- RPO Officer must file FIR within 24 hours for cases involving identity forgery or impersonation
- For internal misconduct: report to the Vigilance Officer of the RPO; if the RPO officer is involved — report directly to MEA Vigilance Wing
- All fraud cases are logged in the PSK Fraud Register and cross-reported to MEA Intelligence Division

2.4 CVC & ACB Referral Matrix

Offence Type	Referral Authority	Action / Outcome
PSK/RPO official accepting bribe	Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) + State ACB	Investigation; prosecution under Prevention of Corruption Act 1988
Police officer demanding payment for PV	State Anti-Corruption Bureau (ACB)	FIR; departmental inquiry; suspension
Broker/agent fraud (not a government servant)	State Police Economic Offences Wing	FIR under IPC; PSK premises ban
High-value document forgery ring	CBI referral via MEA Intelligence Division	Central investigation; coordination with states
Online phishing / fake portal	CERT-In + Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)	Domain takedown; cyber FIR; public advisory

3. Special Escalation Cases

3.1 Disputed Parentage

Cases where the parentage of the applicant (particularly for minors) is disputed between parties are sensitive escalation matters that cannot be resolved by PSK officials alone.

Scenario	Procedure
Both parents dispute authority to apply for minor's passport	Application placed On Hold; both parties notified in writing; referred to Family Court for guardian designation
Non-custodial parent applies without custodial parent's knowledge	Application On Hold pending court-designated guardian order or consent from custodial parent
Parentage disputed with DNA evidence pending	Application deferred until court order received; EscalationTool invoked; RPO awaits court communication
Single parent with death certificate of other parent	Death certificate verified by RPO; Annexure H submitted; application proceeds normally
Surrogate / adoptive parentage	Adoption order / court order mandatory; surrogacy-born applicants require medical documentation
Abandoned minor (child in state care)	State government / Child Welfare Committee letter required; RPO reviews on case-by-case basis

3.2 Repeated Lost Passport Re-issue

Occurrence	Action
First lost passport	Normal re-issue process; FIR required (see KB-PASS-002 Section 3.4)
Second lost passport	Re-issue permitted; flagged in RPO system; additional scrutiny at PV stage
Third or subsequent lost passport	EscalationTool invoked; mandatory RPO personal appearance; joint inquiry by RPO and local police before re-issue
Suspected intentional loss (fraud)	Application referred to MEA Intelligence Division; potential blacklisting of ARN history

3.3 Denied NOC Cases

NOC (No Objection Certificate) denials typically arise when a serving government employee applies for a passport to travel to a sensitive country or when an employee is under departmental inquiry.

NOC Denial Scenario	RPO Action
Central government employee — Ministry denies NOC	Passport application placed On Hold; applicant notified; EscalationTool invoked
State government employee — Department denies NOC	Same as above; applicant must resolve with employer; no RPO override possible
Defence personnel — denied by commanding officer	Mandatory referral to Ministry of Defence liaison office; EscalationTool invoked
Employee under departmental inquiry	Passport may be withheld for duration of inquiry; applicant issued written notice
Employee cleared after inquiry — NOC granted	Application re-activated upon NOC submission; PV re-triggered if more than 90 days have elapsed

4. KB Administration — PassportSahayak AI

4.1 KB Ingestion Process

The Knowledge Base for PassportSahayak AI must be kept current with the latest MEA circulars, SOP revisions, fee changes, and policy updates. KB ingestion is performed via the /kb/ingest API endpoint.

Step	Action	Responsible	Notes
1	Identify new circular / SOP / policy document for ingestion	RPO Operations / KB Admin	Source: official MEA/CPV Division circulars
2	Review document classification: Public / Restricted / Confidential	KB Admin	Restricted/Confidential docs — separate KB partition for officials only
3	Convert document to PDF or DOCX (clean, text-extractable, no scanned images)	KB Admin	Scanned images must be OCR'd before ingestion
4	Call POST /kb/ingest API with document file and metadata fields	KB Admin / System	metadata includes doc_type, version, audience, effective_date
5	System returns HTTP 201 with documentId, chunks_created, ingestion_time_ms	PassportSahayak AI	Verify chunk count > 0; re-submit if ingestion fails
6	Run test query against newly ingested document to validate retrieval accuracy	KB Admin	Use PassportSahayak AI chat; verify citation matches new document
7	Archive previous version of the document with version timestamp	KB Admin	Retain all versions; do not delete — maintain audit trail
8	Update KB Document Control Register with ingestion details	KB Admin	Record: doc_code, version, ingestion date, chunks, admin name

4.2 KB Ingestion API Response Format

Field	Type	Description
documentId	String (UUID)	Unique identifier for the ingested document in the vector store
chunks_created	Integer	Number of text chunks generated from the document (each chunk = one retrieval unit)
ingestion_time_ms	Integer	Time taken to process and embed the document in milliseconds
metadata	Object	doc_type, version, audience, effective_date, tags as provided in the ingestion request

4.3 KB Quality Standards

- Every KB document must have a Document Code, Version, Effective Date, and KB Ingestion Tags

- Documents with overlapping content must be versioned — new version supersedes old; both are retained with version metadata
- No document may be ingested without KB Admin approval
- All KB documents are classified Confidential — PSK/RPO Internal Use Only unless explicitly marked otherwise
- KB documents must not contain applicant-specific PII — all examples must be anonymised
- The similarity threshold for retrieval is set at ≥ 0.5 cosine similarity; documents that do not retrieve cleanly must be re-chunked
- Monthly KB audit: verify all active circulars are ingested; remove superseded documents from the active index

4.4 KB Document Registry

Doc Code	Title	Version	Audience	Status
KB-PASS-001	Passport Types, Categories & Eligibility	v1.0	Applicant Official	Active
KB-PASS-002	Document Checklist & Annexures	v1.0	Applicant Official	Active
KB-PASS-003	Police Verification Procedures	v1.0	Applicant Official	Active
KB-PASS-004	Appointments, Fees & PSK Visit	v1.0	Applicant Official	Active
KB-PASS-005	Application Status, Grievance & Appeals	v1.0	Applicant Official	Active
KB-PASS-006	Official Operations — Counter, SLA & CCTNS	v1.0	Official Only	Active
KB-PASS-007	Fraud, Misconduct & KB Administration	v1.0	Official Only	Active

5. Statutory Compliance Reference

Applicable Law	Provision	Application
Passports Act 1967, Sec 12	Penalty for false statement / suppressing material fact	Prosecution of fraudulent applicants
Prevention of Corruption Act 1988	Bribery by public servant; abuse of official position	CVC/ACB action on officials demanding payment
IPC — Sec 420, 467, 468	Cheating; forgery of documents	FIR for document forgery / impersonation
IT Act 2000, Sec 66C, 66D	Identity theft; impersonation using computer resources	Cyber crime referral for online passport fraud
RTI Act 2005	Citizens may seek information on passport applications	ApplicationStatusTool and RPO are official channels

6. Document Control

Document Owner	RPO Operations — Vigilance & KB Administration
Review Cycle	Annual — reviewed every April
Last Reviewed	April 2024
Next Review	April 2025
Version History	v1.0 (April 2024 — Initial release for PassportSahayak AI KB)
Change Request	Submit PSK-CHG-001 to RPO Operations; approved by Joint Secretary CPV